

• **Local Government in Urban Areas**

1. Introduction

- **Democracy aims to empower citizens to participate in governance.**
- **This participation is called Participatory Democracy.**
- **Urban areas are more complex and diverse than villages, so urban governance is also more complex.**

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2. Urban Local Bodies (ULBs)

- **Local government institutions in cities and towns are called Urban Local Bodies (ULBs).**
- **They are decentralised, meaning local people have a direct role in managing their area.**
- **ULBs help citizens participate in decision-making and local development.**

Importance

- **Bring governance closer to citizens.**
- **Solve local problems efficiently.**
- **Promote democratic participation.**

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3. Structure of Urban Local Government

- **Ward**
- **Cities and towns are divided into smaller units called Wards.**
- **Citizens of a ward elect their representatives.**
- **Ward Committee**

Functions:

- **Conduct health camps.**
- **Organise awareness campaigns.**

Monitor local issues such as:

- **Water leakage**
- **Blocked drains**

- **Damaged roads**
 - **Report problems to authorities.**
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4. Functions of Urban Local Bodies

- **Urban local bodies perform many important services:**
 - **Civic Services**
 - **Garbage collection and disposal**
 - **Maintenance of roads and infrastructure**
 - **Maintenance of burial grounds**
 - **Water supply services**
 - **Administrative Functions**
 - **Implementation of government schemes**
 - **Collection of local taxes and fines**
 - **Issuing licenses and certificates**
 - **Development Functions**
 - **Economic development planning**
 - **Social development planning**
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5. Role of Citizens

- **Urban governance is successful only when citizens cooperate.**
 - **Responsibilities of Citizens**
 - **Segregate waste properly.**
 - **Report water leakages.**
 - **Keep surroundings clean.**
 - **Follow civic rules.**
 - **Participate in community activities.**
 - **Importance**
 - **Citizen participation makes local administration more effective.**
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6. Madras Corporation (Greater Chennai Corporation)

Important Facts

- **Oldest municipal institution in India.**
- **Established on 29 September 1688.**
- **Created by the East India Company.**
- **A Parliamentary Act of 1792 allowed it to levy municipal taxes.**
- **Present Name**
- **Greater Chennai Corporation**

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7. Services Provided by Municipal Corporations

Examples from the Indore Municipal Corporation:

- **Revenue Collection**
- **Property Tax**
- **Water Charges**
- **Public Services**
- **Solid Waste Management**
- **Fire Services**
- **Water Tankers**
- **Ambulance Services**
- **Funeral Vans**
- **Mobile Toilets**
- **Administrative Services**
- **Marriage Certificates**
- **Trade Licenses**
- **Business Licenses**
- **Grievance Redressal**

8. Clean City Example – Indore

- **Indore has been ranked the Cleanest City in India under the Swachh Survekshan scheme for seven consecutive years.**

Citizens played a major role through:

- **Cleanliness**
 - **Waste segregation**
 - **Civic responsibility**
 - **Cooperation with municipal authorities**
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9. Types of Urban Local Bodies

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|---------------------------|--|
| • Population | Urban Local Body |
| • Above 10 lakh | Municipal Corporation (Mahanagar Nigam) |
| • 1 lakh – 10 lakh | Municipal Council (Nagar Palika) |
| • Smaller towns | Nagar Panchayat |

Municipal Corporation

- **Highest urban local body for large cities.**

Municipal Council (Nagar Palika)

- **Governs medium-sized towns and cities.**

Nagar Panchayat

- **Governs smaller towns.**
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10. Funding of Urban Local Bodies

Urban local bodies receive funds through:

- **Property taxes**
- **Water charges**
- **Trade and business licenses**
- **Service fees**
- **Fines and penalties**

11. Rural vs Urban Governance

Rural Areas	Urban Areas
• Gram Sabha	• People of the Ward
• Gram Panchayat	• Ward Committee
• Panchayat Samiti	• Municipal Council/Corporation
• Zila Parishad	• Municipal Corporation/Nagar Palika

Similarities

- **Both are forms of local self-government.**
- **Both have elected representatives.**
- **Both encourage citizen participation.**
- **Both promote local development.**

Differences

- **Rural governance works through Panchayati Raj institutions.**
- **Urban governance works through Urban Local Bodies.**
- **Urban administration is generally more complex because of larger populations and greater diversity.**

Figure 12.2, 12.4 are the heart and core of this chapter and also summarises the chapter.